plausible - probable, likely,
unambiguous - clear
supplication - a humble request, prayer
glistened - shone
gunnel - upper edge of the side of a boat
gurgling - a kind of sound when water is drunk fast

1. Answer the following questions in a sentence or two each, based on your understanding of the story.

a) Describe the pathetic condition of Pi in the middle of the ocean.

b) Who was Richard Parker?

c) Richard Parker's survival seemed incredible to Pi. Why?

d) Why was the great beast not behaving naturally?

e) Why was Pi not afraid of the hyena?

f) Describe Pi's struggle to find drinking water.

g) What was Pi's reaction when he discovered drinking water?

h) Why did Pi want to tame Parker?

i) What saved Pi's life?

j) How did Pi reunite with this family?

2. Answer the following questions in about 50 words.

a) How did the presence of Richard Parker help Pi?

b) Describe the lifeboat.

c) How did Pi feel after drinking water?

d) Did Pi want Richard Parker to die? Answer, giving reasons.

3. Answer in a paragraph.

a) How did the presence of Richard Parker influence the attitude of Pi?

b) Water is the elixir of life. Substantiate the statement with reference to the story of 'Life Of Pi'.

c) If you were lost at sea for as long as Pi was, what is the one item you would want with you? Write a diary entry in which you identify the item and explain why it is the one thing you would want with you.

4. Sequence the following incidents logically to write the summary of the story 'Life of Pi'.

- As he looked around, he was shocked to find Richard Parker on board.
- His search for water took him dangerously close to Richard Parker but nothing could stop him – neither Richard Parker nor the hyena.
- Pi left Richard Parker in a jungle and reunited with his family.
- Pi came back to life and his senses after drinking the elixir of life.
- He understood that it was Richard Parker who helped him survive for 227 days.
- He was pinned by weakness having had no food, water or even sleep for nearly three days.
- Strangely his thirst overpowered his fear of Richard Parker and he went about exploring for fresh water.
- A little later, he succeeded in his search, when he found stacks of cans of drinking water.
- Pi was stranded in the Pacific on a lifeboat.
- Then, he realized that Parker who scared him earlier brought him peace, purpose and wholeness.

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